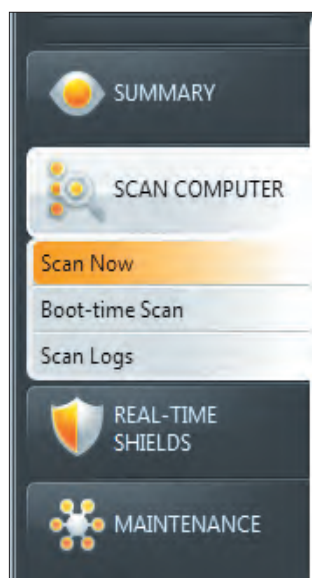




Click on Boot time scan in the left side context menu in the user interface

tings. Kaspersky does not have a boot time feature.

Screensaver mode

Many security suites allow you to run a full system scan whenever the computer is idle. For a lot of systems, a full system scan can slow down your system. In Avast, for example, you can schedule a full system scan whenever your computer is idle by using the anti-virus screensaver feature. It can even be run over your normal screen saver. Whenever your computer is idle for the time that the screensaver is set to come in, Avast will start scanning for viruses and pause immediately once you come back to your computer. To enable this, go to your screensaver properties window and select **Avast! Antivirus** from the list.

In other software suites, it may not be called Screensaver mode. Instead, like Norton, it is referred to as Idle Time Scanning. Norton can perform scheduled scans when your PC is idle if the "Only run at Idle Time" option is selected. Select the **Settings > Task Scheduling > Idle Time** option.

Other systems optimise their scanning to ensure that normal functioning is not disturbed while scanning. Features such as Fast Scan and optimised background scan are prevalent.

Silent mode

Most security suites have realised the importance of disabling notifications so as to improve the user experience. Except TrendMicro, all the security suites we reviewed for features had an option, either as Silent Mode or Gaming mode or a similar name.

Avast has it, in its main user interface. In Kaspersky, right-click on the Kaspersky icon on the taskbar and click on **Settings > Gaming Profile**. Click on enable Gaming Profile. You have the option to disable scans, disable updates, or instead of notification, just take action automatically. Kaspersky chooses the best course of action based on the threat rating and previous choices.

Norton has both options – Full Screen Detection (Gaming mode) and a Silent Mode. It activates automatically when you watch full screen applications. Similarly, Silent Mode is a manual operation to do the same. You can do so by going to **Settings > Administrative Settings**. In the Silent Mode Settings, set the Silent Mode to On. In the Turn on



Mail Shield settings

Silent Mode Box that appears, select the duration from a drop-down list.

AVG Firewall includes a "Game Mode". This can be set under Settings. Alternatively, click on Firewall from the Main Control Center and enable Game Mode.

Anti-spam

If you use webmail services such as Yahoo!, Gmail or Hotmail, chances are email is secure. However, if you're using a client such as Microsoft Outlook or Thunderbird, you have to independently scan your mail for viruses. This feature all security suites have. The new Avast v5, goes one up by having a fully integrated anti-spam feature.

In all security suites, you have the option of customizing the sensitivity level of your detector. Go to Real Time Shields or Email Protector, or Mail Scanner or whatever it is called in your antivirus program, go to settings. Chances are, to specify the level of customisation, you may have

to go to Expert Settings or Advanced Settings.

The same sort of sensitivity specification is not restricted to the Email scanner. All Firewalls also have the same feature (some even have a program specific option).

Auto USB detect

Though the manual scan option is available to scan specific folder files, some security suites can automatically detect when an external drive is plugged in. Some can even erase malware without notifications. If your anti-virus doesn't have this function, it's a good practice to scan your removable media for malware. In AVG, you can go to **Tools > Advanced Settings > Scans > Removable Device Scan**. Tick the checkbox to Automatically Heal / Remove Infections. Kaspersky and Trend Micro have the same feature enabled.

P2P Protection

Frequent downloads from unknown sources using a torrent tracker or a P2P file sharing program often pose a high risk. The security suite monitors all the recognised P2P programs installed for downloads and checks the files as they are downloaded (real-time). Avast has a P2P shield under its list of real-time shields. You can go to Expert Settings and change the list of programs that should be monitored. Kaspersky also has a P2P/File Sharing monitor.



Gaming mode settings